



FOOD FOR THOUGHT

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Sticking to your health resolutions

Here's a nutritionist's guide to **turning intentions into actions** in 2025.

Happy New Year! The air is thick with resolutions. From "This year, I'll finally run that marathon" to "I'll quit sugar (except maybe for birthdays, holidays, and weekends)," we all know the January energy that's often left behind in February's dust.

But what if this year could be different? What if we didn't just make health resolutions but actually stuck to them?

As a nutritionist with over 20 years of experience, I've seen it all: the enthusiasm, the struggle, and the eventual "next year, maybe" promises. Let me tell you a secret — making health resolutions work isn't about willpower. It's about strategy, support, and a little help from technology.

Common hurdles

1. Overambitious goals that backfire

We've all been there. January 1: you decide to eat perfectly balanced meals, work out every day, sleep eight hours, and meditate for an hour — all while juggling work, family, and *Netflix*. By January 15, you're so overwhelmed that the only "resolution" left is a pile of takeaway boxes.

Instead of overloading yourself, focus on one manageable goal. My mantra? "Small changes, big impact." For example, start by drinking more water or adding a vegetable to every meal. It's about progress, not perfection.

2. Meal planning paralysis

Planning meals can feel like solving a Rubik's Cube — on fire. What's healthy? What's quick? What will everyone eat? It's no wonder many people give up and revert to

quick-fix junk food.

Here's where technology becomes your best friend. My app takes the guesswork out of meal planning. With personalised diet plans tailored to your goals, tastes, and even your grocery list, it's like having a nutritionist in your pocket. Whether you're looking for quick recipes or a structured weekly plan, it's got you covered.

3. Unrealistic expectations

"If I'm not down five kilos by the end of January, what's the point?" Sounds familiar? The pressure for instant results often leads to frustration and burnout.

Health is a marathon, not a sprint. My app's tracking feature will help you celebrate small wins, like improved energy or better sleep, rather than fixating on the scale. It's about feeling better, not just looking better.

4. The all-or-nothing mindset

"I ate a slice of pizza, so I've ruined my diet. Might as well have the cake too." This perfectionist mindset is one of the biggest roadblocks to long-term success. Life's too short to ban pizza forever.